

In Class Discussion

EN 601.124: The Ethics of Artificial Intelligence and Automation

Department of Computer Science, January 28th 2026





How could harm have been minimized while conducting a similar experiment on Facebook?

Come up with 5 recommendations in teams.

- Explain your reasoning and arguments.
- Ground each recommendation in relevant ethical concepts like Belmont report, IRB.





What is the concrete value of the scientific evidence?

In what specific ways can it inform either (1) the design of technology, or (2) future studies?



This study used simple keyword matching (LIWC). Nowadays, AI models are used to rank posts.

These models can capture much more nuanced constructs and rank our feeds accordingly.

- What additional risks this create?
- Report 3 specific ethical concerns.



Who should be held accountable?

- List all the specific stakeholders that the Guardian article mentions.
- Discuss what each should have done differently.
- Rank in order in which they should be held accountable (in your view)





Guardian article lists an argument along the lines of "companies do this either way".

What are flaws of such an argument?



**Guardian lists an argument:
strong backlash might dissuade
companies from joining with
science.**

This implies that backlash is harmful
itself.

- Do you agree?
- What is the role of the public?

